

Next book project: The Aesthetics of Metadata: Redaction, Reference, & the Archive in Contemporary Fiction

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I just wanted to share some of the work I've been doing on one of my next book project, which is provisionally entitled *The Aesthetics of Metadata: Redaction, Reference, & the Archive in Contemporary Fiction*. I have roughly 45,000 words of the project down now (of a projected 90,000-word extent) and I also have an emergent structure.

Part I: Introduction

Chapter One: Silence

Part II: The Aesthetics of Metadata

Chapter Two: Redaction

Chapter Three: Reference

Chapter Four: Symptom

Chapter Five: Archive

Chapter Six: Library

Part III: Synthesis

Chapter Seven: Conclusion

Part IV: Surplus

Appendix A: Textual Variants of *_Cloud Atlas_*

Appendix B: *_Cloud Atlas_* Variant JSON Data

Appendix C: Interview with Mark Blacklock

Bibliography

The work will include two previously published, but heavily modified, chapters. Chapter Five, on the Archive, is an extended interpretative/hermeneutic take on ["You have to keep track of your changes": The Version Variants and Publishing History of David Mitchell's *Cloud Atlas*](#) and textual scholarship in the digital looking at texts that feature *archives* while Chapter Four is currently

under submission but looks at objects in Emily St John Mandel's *Station Eleven*. Small portions of the introduction also featured in "On the Political Aesthetics of Metadata", Alluvium, Vol. 5, No. 1 (2016): n. pag. Web. 30 March 2016. <http://dx.doi.org/10.7766/alluvium.v5.1.04>.

So, this is all exciting. I'm hoping to find an open access home for the book as it nears completion later next year.